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serving the interactions between different species, such as the co-operative hunting strategies of lions, or the migratory patterns of wildebeest, deepened my understanding of the dynamics of life. They taught me the importance of teamwork, adaptability and perseverance. I was able to capture some of these moments and experiences.”

Deriving inspiration from American novelist Henry Miller’s words that every destination is a new way of seeing things, Gondal says that the Serengeti’s experience of interdependence and survival, the power of community, resilience, patience, and the beauty of the ecosystem’s diversity had a profoundly enriching effect on him. “Every photograph I took was not just to capture a moment, but a snapshot of a life lesson. The sight of thousands of wildebeest moving together was a testament to the strength of unity and the importance of community support. Watching a lion patiently waiting for the right moment to strike was a lesson in patience and timing. Capturing these reminded me to appreciate the beauty of our differences, and the richness they bring to our world.”

For Gondal, travelling is a therapeutic experience, he says. It provides him with a new environment to think and reflect. “The change of scenery, like when I witnessed the Northern Lights in Iceland, offers fresh perspectives, and often stirs up new ideas.” Like imagining the vastness of the universe, these experiences lead him to insights that he applies in both his personal and professional life. **BT**

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Singing Sensation

Music helps Ashwinder R. Singh, CEO-Residential at Bhartiya Urban, appreciate life in a holistic manner

BY SMITA TRIPATHI

ASHWINDER R. SINGH, CEO-Residential at Bhartiya Urban, an integrated urban township in Bengaluru, is a passionate singer. So much so that in his previous job at Citibank, he was referred to as the ‘Singing Sikh’. “I have always loved singing. It was only when I moved to Bengaluru that I recorded a song and put it up on YouTube. Much to my surprise, it got over 60,000 views,” says the 48-year-old.

The YouTube response encouraged him to record another song. “We recorded a Punjabi folk song, called *Pyar Nal Na Sahi*. There was a lot of positive response. Spotify took that song and I became a verified artist on Spotify.”

A friend ended up sharing the recording with someone at Saregama and they got in touch with him to record a song with them. “So I recorded the third song. They launched it on their YouTube channel, Apple Music and

Spotify,” says Singh, adding that the song got very good feedback and soon Saregama asked him to record a Punjabi song. He sang a Jagjit Singh song called *Chulle Agg* but made it groovy. “It too received very positive feedback.”

Busy with work, Singh says he has not had a chance to go back to the studio, though he hopes to record an original song in the next few months. “I am doing it with a friend who has written and composed it. It’s melodious,” he says. “A lot of people sing but to get professional acclaim is a big high.”

While Singh is completely self-trained, he would like to learn the nuances of singing from a guru. “Singing is meditative for me. It is relaxing. It also makes me very balanced. I believe... music helps me appreciate the nuances of life in a more holistic manner.” **BT**

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PHOTO BY SANDESH RAVIKUMAR

STRIKING THE RIGHT CHORD Called ‘Singing Sikh’ by his colleagues, Singh emotes through music